



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

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— Tantravārttika, Chapter 11, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Tantravārttika guides you towards discerning the subtle layers of spiritual practice, and this verse offers a key. It speaks of navigating a complex landscape within a single path, where four interwoven elements must be understood with clarity, as instructed by the commentator. This 'single path' can be viewed as your own journey of self-discovery, the path of yoga, or any dedicated pursuit of inner growth. The 'four interwoven elements' represent the various aspects of your practice: devotion, knowledge, action, and discernment, each needing careful attention.

The passage then uses analogies. The first highlights a perceived unity based on immediate perception ("padashruti"), contrasted with a stronger influence ("samaanapratyaya shruti") that guides action. Imagine this as your initial understanding of a mantra's meaning versus the transformative power it holds when chanted repeatedly with focused intention. The initial intellectual grasp is weaker than the sustained experience of its effect on your consciousness.

The second analogy speaks of the 'dhatvartha karmatve,' the action and its object, established by direct observation, versus the fulfillment of a higher purpose ("Purushartha") through dedicated practice ("vidhi shruti"). This is akin to performing a selfless act, such as volunteering, where the immediate act of service is guided by a deeper intention – the desire for collective well-being or spiritual growth. The act itself is important, but the underlying motivation, the 'bhava' (feeling), fuels its true significance.

In modern life, you are constantly bombarded with information and demands. This verse reminds you to cultivate discernment. Don't be swayed by superficial appearances or immediate gratifications. Instead, strive to understand the deeper intentions and underlying principles that guide your actions. By carefully examining the motivations behind your choices, and by prioritizing sustained practice over fleeting impulses, you can navigate your path with greater clarity and purpose. The Tantravārttika encourages you to delve deeper, to seek the true meaning beyond the surface.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you prioritizing immediate gratification over long-term spiritual growth in any area of your life, and how can you realign your actions with your deeper values?